

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Cloud Security | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience delivering enterprise-grade cloud and hybrid security engineering. I specialise in evolving security posture across cloud and on-premises environments through SIEM platform management, detection logic development, infrastructure hardening, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have deep, hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, including Kusto Query Language (KQL), analytics rule development, detection rules, workbooks, and logging pipelines, and I am experienced with Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Entra ID, Intune, and the broader Microsoft 365 security stack. I apply established security frameworks including the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework to architect proportionate, auditable security controls. I am experienced in conducting vulnerability management, cloud security assessments, and building automation to deliver scalable, measurable security improvements across complex environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, detection rules, workbooks, logging pipelines, data connectors, Data Collection Rules), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk (SPL)
- **Cloud Security and Identity:** Microsoft Azure / Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Endpoint and XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover), 8,000-user enterprise deployment
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), PowerShell scripting, API integrations, automated enrichment and response workflows
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck; risk-ranked reporting and remediation tracking
- **Security Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard (PCI DSS), SOC 2, MITRE ATT&CK, GDPR
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, least-privilege enforcement, privileged session monitoring
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Additional Security Tools:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight (threat hunting), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Evolve the organisation's security posture across Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, architecting and implementing security controls aligned with NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and MITRE ATT&CK for enterprise threat detection.
- Manage and enhance the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platform, building and optimising detection rules, KQL-based analytics, workbooks, and automated response playbooks (SOAR) to improve detection fidelity and reduce mean time to respond.
- Engineer Sentinel data connectors, Data Collection Rules (DCRs), and logging pipelines, ensuring comprehensive telemetry coverage and data quality across hybrid cloud and on-premises infrastructure for

an 8,000-user environment.

- Build and maintain detection logic at scale using detection-as-code principles and KQL, developing analytics aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to improve detection of advanced threats including lateral movement, credential abuse, and data exfiltration.
- Implement and manage Microsoft Defender XDR, including Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Defender for Office 365, reducing attack surface and driving measurable improvement to the organisation's security baseline.
- Lead incident response operations under the NIST 800-61 framework, performing containment, eradication, and forensic analysis, with timely stakeholder communications and thorough post-incident documentation.
- Conduct threat-hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying undetected adversary activity and reducing dwell time.
- Oversee vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, producing risk-ranked findings and coordinating remediation across infrastructure and application teams.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary SIEM, developing analytics rules, KQL threat-hunting queries, and SOAR playbooks to detect and respond to security threats across the Microsoft 365 estate.
- Hardened Microsoft Azure / Entra ID infrastructure through Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement, SSO configuration, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) controls, significantly reducing identity attack surface.
- Managed Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS vulnerability management programmes; triaged and tracked remediation of critical findings, producing board-level reporting on security posture.
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM, enforcing least-privilege access and ensuring privileged session audit trails across on-premises and cloud environments.
- Managed Intune MDM/MAM for mobile device policy enforcement and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR for endpoint protection, improving endpoint security baseline across the user estate.
- Maintained ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST CSF, and CIS Controls compliance, producing technical control documentation and supporting external audit and certification processes.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented security controls across the cloud-hosted SaaS infrastructure, including Check Point Harmony firewall policy management, network segmentation, and endpoint hardening.
- Managed Azure Active Directory identities, MFA, SSO, and Conditional Access policies for cloud-hosted applications, maintaining secure access for a globally distributed workforce.
- Administered Mimecast email security gateway to reduce phishing and business email compromise risk, performing regular log review and threat investigation.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning, risk assessments, and compliance reviews, reporting findings with risk rankings and remediation recommendations to management.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance and internal security audit processes, producing control evidence and supporting annual certification activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender XDR across an 8,000-user environment, delivering comprehensive endpoint, identity, and email security coverage and driving a measurable improvement to the organisation's security baseline.
- Architected and deployed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with a full suite of KQL-based analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, eliminating critical detection blind spots and improving mean time to detect security incidents.
- Designed SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage, enrichment, and containment workflows, significantly reducing mean time to respond and analyst workload.

- Implemented and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM ingestion pipelines, achieving high telemetry fidelity and measurably reducing false-positive alert rates through systematic rule tuning.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification by implementing all required technical controls and producing comprehensive audit documentation across the IT estate.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)